

Part III: Object-Oriented Python

Chapter 15: Object-Oriented Programming and Classes Defines the role of object-oriented programming (OOP) because it's often misunderstood. Many developers overuse OOP techniques in their code because they believe it's what everyone else does, but this leads to complicated source code. This chapter teaches you how to write classes, but more important, it teaches you why you should and shouldn't use them.

Chapter 16: Object-Oriented Programming and Inheritance Explains class inheritance and its utility for code reuse.

Chapter 17: Pythonic OOP: Properties and Dunder Methods Covers the Python-specific features in object-oriented design, such as properties, dunder methods, and operator overloading.

Your Programming Journey

The journey from novice to capable programmer can often feel like attempting to drink from a fire hose. With so many resources to choose from, you might worry that you're wasting time on suboptimal programming guides.

After you finish reading this book (or even while you're reading this book), I recommend following up by reading these additional introductory materials:

Python Crash Course (No Starch Press, 2019) by Eric Matthes is a book for beginners, but its project-based approach gives even experienced programmers a taste of Python's Pygame, matplotlib, and Django libraries.

Impractical Python Projects (No Starch Press, 2018) by Lee Vaughan provides a project-based approach to expand your Python skills. The programs you'll create by following the instructions in this book are fun and great programming practice.